

Building Technology

Basic Mathematics I

Comprehensive Learner Notes

Prepared for engineering and technical trainees using a CBET-oriented learning approach.

Item	Details
Department	Building Technology
Topic	Basic Mathematics I
Purpose	Support technical learners with concepts, formulas, examples, exercises and engineering applications.
Reference anchors	K.A. Stroud, John Bird, and local TVET curriculum framework.

How to Use These Notes

Engineering mathematics should be studied actively. Read the explanation, copy the key formula, then attempt the examples without looking at the solution. After solving a problem, write one sentence explaining what the answer means in the engineering context.

- Write formulas before substituting values.
- Keep units consistent throughout the calculation.
- Avoid rounding too early.
- Check whether the answer is reasonable for the workplace problem.
- Use the exercises to prepare for CATs, assignments and summative assessment.

Formula Summary

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/bd$$

Interpret the symbols carefully before using the formula. A formula is only useful when the learner understands the quantities represented by each term.

$$\text{Percentage} = (\text{Part/Whole}) \times 100\%$$

Interpret the symbols carefully before using the formula. A formula is only useful when the learner understands the quantities represented by each term.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Interpret the symbols carefully before using the formula. A formula is only useful when the learner understands the quantities represented by each term.

$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

Interpret the symbols carefully before using the formula. A formula is only useful when the learner understands the quantities represented by each term.

$$\text{Area: } A = lw$$

Interpret the symbols carefully before using the formula. A formula is only useful when the learner understands the quantities represented by each term.

Chapter 1.1: Whole Numbers and Decimals

This section develops whole numbers and decimals for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving site measurement.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving site measurement. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 1.2: Whole Numbers and Decimals

This section develops whole numbers and decimals for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wall length calculations.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wall length calculations. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

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Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
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3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 1.3: Whole Numbers and Decimals

This section develops whole numbers and decimals for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving material quantity checks.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Area: } A = lw$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving material quantity checks. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
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- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 1.4: Whole Numbers and Decimals

This section develops whole numbers and decimals for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving mortar ratios.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/bd$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving mortar ratios. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

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Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
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5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 1.5: Whole Numbers and Decimals

This section develops whole numbers and decimals for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wastage allowance.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Percentage} = (\text{Part/Whole}) \times 100\%$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wastage allowance. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
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5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 1.6: Whole Numbers and Decimals

This section develops whole numbers and decimals for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving site measurement.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving site measurement. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

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6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 1.7: Whole Numbers and Decimals

This section develops whole numbers and decimals for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wall length calculations.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wall length calculations. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

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In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

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Chapter 2.1: Fractions in Construction

This section develops fractions in construction for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wall length calculations.

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$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

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Chapter 2.2: Fractions in Construction

This section develops fractions in construction for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving material quantity checks.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Area: } A = lw$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving material quantity checks. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

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Chapter 2.3: Fractions in Construction

This section develops fractions in construction for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving mortar ratios.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/bd$$

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Chapter 2.4: Fractions in Construction

This section develops fractions in construction for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wastage allowance.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Percentage} = (\text{Part/Whole}) \times 100\%$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wastage allowance. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

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Practice tasks

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5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 2.5: Fractions in Construction

This section develops fractions in construction for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving site measurement.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving site measurement. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

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6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 2.6: Fractions in Construction

This section develops fractions in construction for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wall length calculations.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wall length calculations. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

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4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 2.7: Fractions in Construction

This section develops fractions in construction for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving material quantity checks.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Area: } A = lw$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving material quantity checks. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

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Practice tasks

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5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 3.1: Percentages

This section develops percentages for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving material quantity checks.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Area: } A = lw$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving material quantity checks. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

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Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
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6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 3.2: Percentages

This section develops percentages for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving mortar ratios.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/bd$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving mortar ratios. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

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Practice tasks

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6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 3.3: Percentages

This section develops percentages for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wastage allowance.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Percentage} = (\text{Part/Whole}) \times 100\%$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wastage allowance. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

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4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 3.4: Percentages

This section develops percentages for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving site measurement.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving site measurement. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 3.5: Percentages

This section develops percentages for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wall length calculations.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wall length calculations. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 3.6: Percentages

This section develops percentages for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving material quantity checks.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Area: } A = lw$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving material quantity checks. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 3.7: Percentages

This section develops percentages for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving mortar ratios.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/bd$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving mortar ratios. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 4.1: Ratios and Proportions

This section develops ratios and proportions for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving mortar ratios.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/bd$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving mortar ratios. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
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- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 4.2: Ratios and Proportions

This section develops ratios and proportions for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wastage allowance.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Percentage} = (\text{Part/Whole}) \times 100\%$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wastage allowance. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 4.3: Ratios and Proportions

This section develops ratios and proportions for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving site measurement.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving site measurement. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

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- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

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3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 4.4: Ratios and Proportions

This section develops ratios and proportions for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wall length calculations.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wall length calculations. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
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- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 4.5: Ratios and Proportions

This section develops ratios and proportions for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving material quantity checks.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Area: } A = lw$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving material quantity checks. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 4.6: Ratios and Proportions

This section develops ratios and proportions for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving mortar ratios.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/bd$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving mortar ratios. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 4.7: Ratios and Proportions

This section develops ratios and proportions for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wastage allowance.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Percentage} = (\text{Part/Whole}) \times 100\%$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wastage allowance. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 5.1: Measurement Units

This section develops measurement units for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wastage allowance.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Percentage} = (\text{Part/Whole}) \times 100\%$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wastage allowance. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 5.2: Measurement Units

This section develops measurement units for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving site measurement.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving site measurement. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 5.3: Measurement Units

This section develops measurement units for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wall length calculations.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wall length calculations. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 5.4: Measurement Units

This section develops measurement units for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving material quantity checks.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Area: } A = lw$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving material quantity checks. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 5.5: Measurement Units

This section develops measurement units for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving mortar ratios.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/bd$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving mortar ratios. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 5.6: Measurement Units

This section develops measurement units for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wastage allowance.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Percentage} = (\text{Part/Whole}) \times 100\%$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wastage allowance. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
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Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 5.7: Measurement Units

This section develops measurement units for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving site measurement.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving site measurement. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 6.1: Building Site Calculations

This section develops building site calculations for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving site measurement.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving site measurement. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 6.2: Building Site Calculations

This section develops building site calculations for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wall length calculations.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wall length calculations. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 6.3: Building Site Calculations

This section develops building site calculations for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving material quantity checks.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Area: } A = lw$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving material quantity checks. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 6.4: Building Site Calculations

This section develops building site calculations for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving mortar ratios.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/bd$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving mortar ratios. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 6.5: Building Site Calculations

This section develops building site calculations for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wastage allowance.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Percentage} = (\text{Part/Whole}) \times 100\%$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wastage allowance. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 6.6: Building Site Calculations

This section develops building site calculations for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving site measurement.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Ratio} = a : b$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving site measurement. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Chapter 6.7: Building Site Calculations

This section develops building site calculations for building technology practice. The focus is on using mathematics to solve realistic technical problems involving wall length calculations.

Concept explanation

A professional technician must understand both the calculation procedure and the meaning of the answer. In engineering mathematics, symbols represent measurable quantities such as distance, level, area, volume, force, cost, time, observation, coordinate or probability. Correct interpretation prevents wrong site decisions.

$$\text{Perimeter: } P = 2(l + w)$$

Worked example

Example: A building technology trainee is given a task involving wall length calculations. The problem requires selecting a suitable formula, substituting known values, simplifying carefully and interpreting the final result.

Solution method: identify the known information, write the formula, substitute values, simplify step by step, attach units and state whether the result is reasonable.

Engineering interpretation

In building technology, this result may help in checking dimensions, comparing field observations, estimating quantities, verifying design assumptions, or deciding whether further investigation is needed.

Common errors

- Substituting values before checking units.
- Using a formula that does not match the situation.
- Losing negative signs or angle direction.
- Rounding intermediate values too early.
- Giving a numerical answer without engineering interpretation.

Practice tasks

1. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
2. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving mortar ratios. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
3. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wastage allowance. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
4. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving site measurement. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
5. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving wall length calculations. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.
6. Create and solve a building technology calculation involving material quantity checks. Show formula, substitution, computation, units and interpretation.

Mixed Revision Questions

1. A building technology task involves wastage allowance. Formulate the mathematical model, solve the problem and interpret the answer.
2. A building technology task involves site measurement. Formulate the mathematical model, solve the problem and interpret the answer.
3. A building technology task involves wall length calculations. Formulate the mathematical model, solve the problem and interpret the answer.
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59. A building technology task involves material quantity checks. Formulate the mathematical model, solve the problem and interpret the answer.
60. A building technology task involves mortar ratios. Formulate the mathematical model, solve the problem and interpret the answer.

References and Further Reading

These notes are original learning materials prepared for Mr Mwirigi Mathematics Training Hub. They are academically informed by standard engineering mathematics texts and the local TVET curriculum framework. No textbook pages or worked examples have been copied.

1. Stroud, K. A. and Booth, D. J. Engineering Mathematics, 8th edition. Bloomsbury Academic.
2. Bird, J. Engineering Mathematics. Routledge / Taylor & Francis.
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4. Relevant Civil Engineering, Building Technology and Land Survey curriculum and occupational standard documents.